
EN578-26ISC1 solicitation Amendment

This solicitation Amendment 002 is raised to answer Offeror's questions:

Respond to questions from industry.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

Question #1: A proposed quantum sensor requires cryogenic cooling to operate and be tested effectively. Could you please confirm whether testing setups involving cryogenic systems are supported within this call?

Answer #1: The Government of Canada has multiple locations where cryogenic cooling might be accessible to perform the testing campaign. In the event where there is no room to support testing then cryogenic systems could be supported via a subcontractor or third party.

Question #2: With respect to the Supplier verification and decentralized credentialing problem statement: Can Canada clarify how "Government of Canada supplier" status should be defined, validated, and represented within proposed solutions under this problem statement? Specifically:

- a. What type of status or attribute is intended (e.g., supplier registration, prequalification, or contractual relationship)?
- b. Is there an expected or authoritative public data source that should be used to determine and verify this status?
- c. If no single source is prescribed, can offerors propose their own source-of-truth approach (e.g., using open data or synthetic data for demonstration purposes)?
- d. Should any resulting credential or claim be strictly limited to what can be validated from the underlying data source?
- e. How should offerors account for situations where required data is not publicly available (e.g., use of test datasets or data provided during SOW development)?

Answer #2:

- a. The status should reflect that a supplier is a recipient of a federal contract award and is in good standing.
- b. There will be an authoritative, public data source available to determine and verify this status. However, that source does not exist and is not yet determined.

- c. No, as per above.
- d. Yes, credentials have to be supported by the sources which are publicly available, verifiable, and up to date.
- e. Until the public source specific to this requirement is available, fields from the procurement data on Open Government datasets will be used as test data.

Question #3: Section 4.3 c) suggests that the offer will be deemed complete upon c) acceptance of the terms and conditions of.... the resulting contract. Section 13.5 c) suggests that there will be contract negotiations that take place after competition of the SOW and the cost breakdown exercise. Are the “Resulting Contract Clauses” forming part of the solicitation document negotiable, as the steps would suggest or must we agree to the terms upon submitting our offer per Section 4.3 c)?

Answer #3: The clauses found in the sample draft contract are an example of the clauses that may appear in a resulting contract. The text of the clauses that appear are not negotiable. Clauses that appear in a resulting contract will be chosen based on the innovation and resulting test plan. For example, a test of a software innovation with no hardware component will result in the removal of the hardware specific clauses from the sample document. Likewise, a test of a hardware innovation with no software component will result in the removal of the software specific clauses.

There may also be instances where clauses that do not appear in the sample document are included in a resulting contract. Any clauses that do not appear in the sample document are negotiable.